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Classroom Assignment Sheet

161022

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Question - Discuss the reasons for the failure of the 1857 revolt, focusing on the absence of central leadership & lack of pan-India Nationalism.

Though the revolt of 1857 was localized and fragmented, it did not achieved political independence but it was successful in igniting "Anti-colonial consciousness". It became a perennial source of inspiration for later generations and marked a transition from Company rule to crown rule, inaugurating a new phase in India's freedom struggle.

Reasons for failure

① Lack of unity

a) There was no feeling or emotion of PAN-India Nationalism.

b) Parochial in Nature - The sepoys in one region fought for religious reasons while sepoys in other for economic reasons.

c) Intelligentsia class of India - Moneylenders, Zamindars, rich class did not supported the revolt as they felt it is "backward looking" & "Conservative".

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1) Absence of central leadership.

c) Personal agenda - Muslim community wanted to restore the glory of Mughal Kingdom while Hindus wanted their own rule.

② Lack of International support - Ottoman empire showed sympathy for the rebels but did not provided assistance but the European powers supported British with resources.

③ Obsolete weapons - British Sepoys had sophisticated weapons including Artillery, Rifle muskets etc. whereas Indian Sepoys lacked modern weapons.

④ Geographical barrier - made South India relatively less affected by the revolt due to lack of communication.

⑤ Technology - British used Railways and Telegraph Services to coordinate with the Army and new developments.

⑥ Sikhs did not supported the Rebels - due to the martyrdoms of their Gurus by Mughal rulers in the past.

Even though the Revolt of 1857 failed, it implanted the seeds of "Nationalism" that took roots in the late 1800s in India.

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